As a TV Israeli commentator said quite correctly, all these are tactical successes, but they do not change anything on a strategic level. What is changing is the patience of Netanyahu and the Likud in the face of constant self-congratulation by Ben-Gvir. It has reached the point (which even I have noticed) that the TV transmits images from cabinet meetings in which almost all members are depicted except Ben-Gvir. But how will Netanyahu get rid of the evil clown without bringing the coalition down? Will Gantz be ready to save him?

There are previous cases of entrenched disagreement between a prime minister and an independent-minded member of the government: Ben-Gurion versus Pinhas Lavon and Sharett, Begin versus Sharon, Rabin versus Peres. Either the confrontation ultimately brought the removal of the head of government or of the independent-minded minister, or it led to a pseudo-reconciliation, but it did not affect the ascendency of the major party and the governing coalition. Now the situation is by far more critical.

Let me repeat: the present internal situation goes far beyond a purely political crisis. We are facing a major social crisis, whereby the country is divided between a liberal and liberal-observant, in majority Ashkenazi, part of society, facing a mostly Orthodox segment, in part Mizrahi (but not only), and with both sides having to contend with the aggressive policy of the prosettler party. In other terms, deep social resentment and fanatic messianic dreams are mixed with political calculations. All this has existed for a long time but was papered over until this fragile concealment collapsed thanks to the demands of the various parties of the present coalition.

In the meantime, the attacks on and from Gaza have certainly put an end to demonstrations. It won’t be easy to renew them, and if this was engineered by Netanyahu, it was clever in the immediate term, but not in the long run. The trouble is that we don’t know the real causes of this so-called war.